

With biometrics, our movements from office to work could be tracked easily using various security cameras deployed on the road

terns and then using them as a database to authenticate a subject.

Voice recognition is often confused with speech recognition, which is a technology that converts speech to text and the conversion software needs to go through extensive training by the user before any suitable and acceptable results are obtained.

Voice recognition works by noting a person's voice (physical characteristics of the vocal tract, the harmonic and the resonant frequencies) and converts it into an audio file which is known as a voice print.

During the creation of a voice print, the subject is asked to choose a phrase and asked to repeat it. The phrase should be 1 to 1.5 seconds in length since a smaller phrase provides the system with too little data, and beyond that, too much data. Both of these conditions result in reduced accuracy. The problem with voice recognition does not lie in its integrity since it's near impossible to fake a voice. The problem lies with the technology we are using to implement it with.

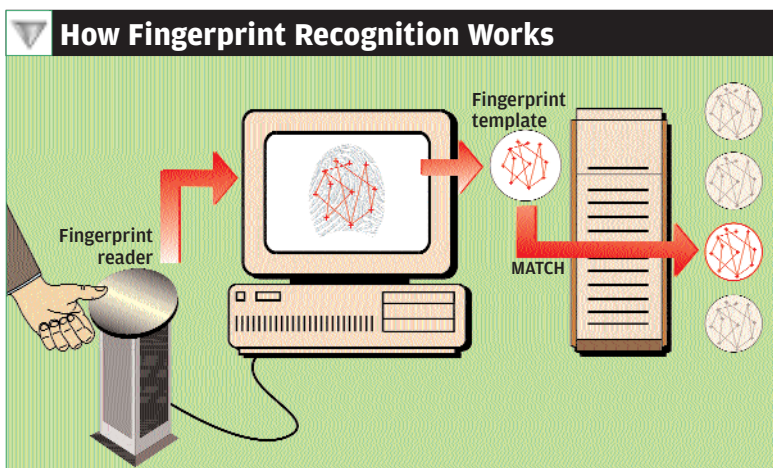
In the confined environs of a test lab, the technology is at par with other biometric technologies but in the real world tests, it has to contend with background noise, weather conditions, audio source and the like. Consider these two scenarios:

First: First, say you need to get inside your house which is "voice-locked"; meaning it has a voice recognition-based security system.

Now, if there is a traffic jam on the street in front of your house, horns blaring, people screaming, the system might refuse to authenticate you due to too much background noise (try using voice dialling in your cell phone in room full of chattering people and you'll understand what we are talking about).

In fact, it might also fail to authenticate you if you have a sore throat or are suffering from a cold as it alters your voice (and hence the voice print) quite considerably!

Second: Voice recognition can use any plain audio source, such as telephones, cell phones, etc., to authenticate the user but herein lies the catch: if you use a different phone than the type used during registration (creation of voice print in the database), the system might not authenticate you. This happens because the voice data that the



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